

A CLEARER WAY THROUGH 72 DEVTOOLS MOVES

Devtools marketing swipe file

2016 to 2026 | Reader edition

A practical scan of the moves, evidence and OneFlux applications in the original research file.

READ FIRST

The next pages show the recurring patterns and 15 low-cost moves that fit the current calendar.

THEN BROWSE

The 72 case studies are grouped by channel. Each starts with why the move mattered, followed by the action, evidence, cost and OneFlux use.

USE THE APPENDIX

The original discarded-candidates tables are retained at the back for source traceability.

Scope and status

As of 6 Oct 2026. Owner: Rohit. This is research, tier 5 in the authority order. It is an idea bank, not an approved plan or spending authority. The original file covers the wider devtools decade; direct AI-coding competitors have a separate 25-item guide.

Start with five patterns

These patterns recur across the 72 examples. Use them to decide which case studies deserve a closer read.

1 Give engineers a useful asset

Docs, manuals, methods and free tools can earn trust before the product is evaluated. Stripe, PagerDuty, Basecamp and Algolia show different versions of this.

2 Name the work buyers already see

A category or job title helps teams explain a new budget. Honeycomb, dbt, Humanitec and AI Engineer built audiences around a shared vocabulary.

3 Make proof repeatable

A benchmark or study travels further when people can check the method. Public failures and weak demos can also travel; Devin is the cautionary example.

4 Let developer use support enterprise sales

Individual adoption can open the account. Governance, security, procurement and services then make the purchase possible. Snyk, HashiCorp and Cursor illustrate the sequence.

5 Design for agents and existing budgets

Agents increasingly read docs and create free accounts. For enterprise buyers, marketplaces, systems integrators and tools already in the workflow can shorten distribution and purchasing.

Find a case study

The case studies keep the source numbers. PDF bookmarks also let you jump to a section or company.

01-06 Docs and reference

Start with Stripe, Twilio.

07-12 Launch mechanics

Start with Supabase, Resend.

13-18 Open source as distribution

Start with HashiCorp, Sentry.

19-26 Content and voice

Start with Stripe, PostHog.

27-31 Developer events and community

Start with dbt Labs, Humanitec.

32-36 Pricing and packaging

Start with GitHub, Cursor.

37-41 Enterprise sales with developer credibility

Start with Snyk, Palantir, then OpenAI.

42-47 Proof, benchmarks and public failure

Start with GitHub, Augment Code.

48-51 Marketplaces and partner channels

Start with CrowdStrike and Datadog, Atlassian Marketplace.

52-55 Product growth loops

Start with Statuspage, Anthropic.

56-61 Education and India programmes

Start with Microsoft, CNCF.

62-68 Field marketing and enterprise programmes

Start with MongoDB and Snowflake, Confluent.

69-72 Brand, dates and standards

Start with Cloudflare, GitHub.

15 moves for the current leg

These follow the source GTM-v2 calendar and budget lines. They are research suggestions, not approved work. Ask Gartner which evaluations OneFlux could enter and when (case 39).

01 Publish a weekly changelog in the website nav.

From 31 Oct | Product and content; no spend | Cases 9

02 Open a qualified design-partner waitlist; publish the count before launch.

From 31 Oct; pricing on 19 Jan | Website and GrowthSpree | Cases 12, 33

03 Measure OneFlux use inside Capillary, then publish the number at launch.

Start in October | Product; no spend | Cases 11

04 Run "Spec with agents" workshops; turn the method into a free book and page.

Nov-Dec; publish 19 Jan | Content and Goosewin prep | Cases 24, 21

05 Publish a named engineering leader's thesis on why the loop closes at Spec.

Early December | Goosewin on X and LinkedIn | Cases 25, 23, 30

06 Ship agent-readable docs and a sandbox quickstart that works on first paste.

December self-serve entry | Goosewin docs and cookbook | Cases 4, 1, 3

07 Run launch week with one module a day and partner sign-off.

19-23 Jan | Goosewin and launch media | Cases 7, 8

08 Open-source a manual for using agents across the SDLC, with recipes.

Launch week | Content | Cases 6, 18, 16

15 moves for the current leg

Continued: the next seven moves.

09 Shape the Research NXT survey around the OneFlux gap; map metrics to DORA.

Design now; report 27-29 Jan | Research NXT | Cases 40, 41, 42

10 Run capped, application-only VP roundtables and a co-presented PlatformCon talk.

Jan-Feb | Research NXT and travel | Cases 30, 27, 29, 28

11 List on AWS Marketplace with a private-offer template, including INR.

By 19 Jan | Commercial and finance | Cases 48

12 Add default co-author, PR and on-call attribution, each with an admin switch.

December entry | Product | Cases 52, 53

13 Issue vouchers for category-named roundtables; rank invites by engineer activity.

Codes in December | Research NXT and GrowthSpree | Cases 62, 63, 65

14 Recruit 10-20 GCC champions and reveal one India-only offer at the roundtables.

Recruit in November | Influencer line | Cases 61, 59

15 Sign one systems integrator as customer zero and publish usage together.

Before 19 Jan | Rohit and Sales | Cases 50

Bigger bets for the April-March plan

The source file parks these for a later planning cycle.

- Offer free Review on public repos with a running counter (35, 5).
- Put a forward-deployed engineering pod on the first ABM accounts (38).
- Start with an engineering-manager newsletter, then consider a themed quarterly (20, 19).
- Sponsor one Indian engineering podcast or channel for a year (26).
- Make the free tier callable by other agents over MCP (36, 34).
- Run a pre-registered randomised study with an outside lab (42).
- Qualify for Azure Marketplace where GCC buyers use Microsoft agreements (48).
- Build a four-module certification and a Nasscom FutureSkills Prime course (57, 56, 58).
- Commission a value study after four or five design partners are live (66).
- Package modernisation with a price, method and named engineers (68).

Five mistakes to avoid

- Do not build a demo that outsiders cannot reproduce (10).
- Do not change individual pricing without warning after launch (33).
- Do not change the licence after a community has adopted the code (13).
- Do not rely only on docs page views for paid conversion; agents can absorb that traffic (3).
- Do not put a developer paywall in front of an enterprise category (37).

How the case studies were edited

The next 72 cases have been rewritten as shorter business summaries. The move, reason it worked, and OneFlux application are new prose. Reported figures, qualifications, costs and source notes remain from the research file.

Read the evidence carefully

Company-reported means the vendor supplied the figure. Third-party means an outside source reported it. Inferred marks an interpretation; unverified means the claim could not be confirmed. A result alongside a marketing move does not prove the move caused it.

Trace a detail

Every case shows its page in the original PDF. Use that page when you need the full chronology or wording behind a summary.

01 / DOCS AND REFERENCE

01 Stripe: docs that run on the reader's own key, and an API that never breaks (2011 to 2022)

WHY IT WORKED

A working sample makes the docs a product trial. Version pinning gives enterprise buyers confidence that integrations will not break without warning.

WHAT THEY DID

Stripe personalised code samples with each reader's test key and kept accounts on dated API versions. It also made documentation an engineering responsibility.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Compatibility kept with every API version since 2011, across "almost a hundred backwards-incompatible upgrades" in six years [company-reported]. The career-ladder practice comes from a former Stripe docs manager, via Mintlify [third-party]. No traffic or conversion number exists.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Let readers run the quickstart in their own sandbox with their repo filled in. Publish a pinned versioning policy for agent behaviour at launch.

COST

Not documented. The old docs platform held hundreds of pages maintained by many teams.

SOURCES

How Stripe builds interactive docs with Markdoc, 13 Sep 2022; APIs as infrastructure, 5 Aug 2017; Mintlify on Stripe docs, 10 Nov 2023

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 7.

02 / DOCS AND REFERENCE

02 Twilio: "Ask Your Developer" (billboard c.2016, book 2021)

WHY IT WORKED

The line let developer familiarity make the case to executives without explaining the product on the billboard.

WHAT THEY DID

Twilio ran billboards with only "Ask Your Developer" and later expanded the line into a book.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Widely discussed in tech press and podcasts [third-party], qualitative. No campaign metrics found. The billboard year is [unverified].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Test a VP Engineering line such as "Ask your on-call engineer" with GCC leaders on LinkedIn before buying outdoor media.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Raman Sharma, 23 Nov 2021; TechCrunch, 15 Jan 2021

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 7.

03 / DOCS AND REFERENCE

03 Tailwind: free docs selling a paid kit, and what happened when agents took the traffic (2017 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

Frequent docs visits made paid conversion cheap while developers still came to the site.

WHAT THEY DID

Tailwind used free framework docs to sell a book and paid component kit. The model weakened when AI assistants began answering questions without sending people to the docs.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Tailwind UI was "about to cross \$2 million in revenue" five months after launch [company-reported]. In January 2026 Adam Wathan said docs traffic was down about 40% from early 2023, revenue was down close to 80%, and 75% of engineering had been let go, because AI assistants answer without sending readers to the docs [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Keep docs useful, but put a route to the paid product inside OneFlux output, such as a link on a generated spec.

COST

A small team; three hired developers named in 2020 company-reported.

SOURCES

Adam Wathan, 2 Aug 2020; tailwindcss.com PR #2388, 6 Jan 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 8.

04 / DOCS AND REFERENCE

04 Mintlify: docs written for agents as well as people (2025 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

Coding agents now read docs and influence which tools enter a workflow. Clean agent-readable content improves that path.

WHAT THEY DID

Mintlify made docs available as llms.txt, Markdown and MCP, then reported agent and human traffic separately.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Agents were 66% of measured traffic across Mintlify-hosted docs in July 2026 (213M agent requests against 105M human page loads), up from 15.2% at the start of 2026 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Ship agent-readable docs with the December entry point. Test whether Claude Code and Codex can install OneFlux without help, and publish the result.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Mintlify, State of docs traffic, 29 Jul 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 8.

05 / DOCS AND REFERENCE

05 Algolia: DocSearch, free search on other people's docs in exchange for a logo (2016)

WHY IT WORKED

Each search demonstrated Algolia on a trusted third-party site, in front of developers who might later buy it.

WHAT THEY DID

Algolia offered free search to open-source documentation sites in return for visible attribution beside search results.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

8,000+ sites and 170M searches a month [company-reported], Oct 2023. The docsearch repo has 4,375 stars [third-party], GitHub API, Oct 2026.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Offer free agent review on public RFCs, with a short attribution on each comment that links back to OneFlux Spec.

COST

Algolia pays crawl and hosting; amount not documented.

SOURCES

Algolia, 17 Oct 2023; DocSearch program terms

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 9.

06 / DOCS AND REFERENCE

o6 PagerDuty: open-sourced its own incident-response manual (2017)

WHY IT WORKED

Teams could adopt PagerDuty's roles and language before buying the tool, making the product fit their established process.

WHAT THEY DID

PagerDuty published a cleaned-up version of its incident-response manual under Apache 2.0.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

1,053 stars and 219 forks [third-party], GitHub API, Oct 2026. Covered by SD Times on 4 Jan 2017 [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish a forkable manual for agents across spec, code, review and on-call, including escalation and human approval rules.

COST

Editing existing internal docs for public use; not documented.

SOURCES

SD Times, 4 Jan 2017; response.pagerduty.com/about

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 9.

07 / LAUNCH MECHANICS

07 Supabase: Launch Week, every quarter (2021 onward)

WHY IT WORKED

The schedule gave the team a shipping deadline and gave press, partners and developers several chances to pay attention.

WHAT THEY DID

Supabase turned a single launch into a repeatable week: one major release each weekday, supported by smaller releases, a hackathon and meetups.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Managed databases grew 47% month on month for 18 months, at 30 staff, by Nov 2021 [company-reported]. June 2026: \$10.5B valuation, nearly 10M developers, over 60% of new databases started by AI tools [third-party], TechCrunch. Launch Week can't be separated from other causes [inferred].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Launch OneFlux over 19-23 January, with one module a day, and put the next launch week on the calendar now.

COST

Not documented. The whole company works to the deadline.

SOURCES

Supabase, How we launch, 26 Nov 2021; Supabase Launch Week; TechCrunch, 5 Jun 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 10.

08 / LAUNCH MECHANICS

o8 Resend: open-source companion first, then a launch week on a small budget (2022 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

The free tool solved an adjacent problem and created demand. Early testing made each launch easier for users to endorse.

WHAT THEY DID

Resend released the free React Email library before its paid API. Later it prepared five requested features behind flags and launched one each day.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Launch tweet past 1M views (Jan 2023), 1,000 paying customers by Dec 2023, 3M users by Jun 2026 [company-reported]. React Email has 19,812 stars [third-party], GitHub API. A 45% rise in impressions over the previous launch week [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Release an open spec format first. Build launch-week features from design-partner requests and ask the requesting partner to co-sign each post.

COST

Low. Videos were shot with a tripod, a basic microphone and natural light company-reported.

SOURCES

Resend, How we got here; Resend, Launch Week behind the scenes, 11 Apr 2025; GitHub, resend/react-email

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 10.

09 / LAUNCH MECHANICS

09 Linear: the changelog as the marketing channel (2019 onward)

WHY IT WORKED

A steady record of shipping gave buyers and recruits visible proof of product momentum using work the team had already done.

WHAT THEY DID

Linear made a short public changelog part of its regular release process and main site navigation.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

50+ changelogs and 1,000+ followers in the first year [company-reported]. 192 entries from April 2019 to March 2025, with only two 30-day gaps [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Start a weekly changelog with the 31 October site and keep it in the top navigation.

COST

A few hours a week, rotated inferred.

SOURCES

Linear, Startups write changelogs, 18 May 2020; Changebot, 7 Mar 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 11.

10 / LAUNCH MECHANICS

10 Cognition: Devin's launch video, the benchmark, and the debunk (2024)

WHY IT WORKED

A clear category and checkable number spread quickly, but a demo that failed scrutiny damaged trust.

WHAT THEY DID

Cognition introduced Devin with a category claim, launch video, benchmark and waitlist. A later Upwork demo was challenged publicly.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Valuation went from \$350M to about \$2B within about a month; ARR from \$1M (Sep 2024) to \$73M (Jun 2025) [third-party], Contrary. An engineer showed the Upwork video misrepresented the task, and Answer.AI later found Devin solved 3 of 20 tasks [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Give every launch demo a reproducible repo, prompt, timing and failure record. Say those limits on screen.

COST

Credibility. Cognition moved to "far from perfect" wording third-party.

SOURCES

Cognition, Introducing Devin, 12 Mar 2024; Cognition, SWE-bench technical report, 15 Mar 2024; Answer.AI, 8 Jan 2025; Contrary Research

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 11.

11 / LAUNCH MECHANICS

11 Anthropic: Claude Code, heavy internal use and then a "research preview" (2024 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Internal use supplied real feedback and a credible adoption story; preview positioning set expectations for early users.

WHAT THEY DID

Anthropic tested Claude Code internally, then launched it as a limited research preview alongside a model announcement.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 70 to 80% of technical staff used it daily during development, with "a post every five minutes" in the feedback channel [company-reported]. Over \$500M run-rate revenue and usage up more than 10x in the three months after GA [company-reported], Sep 2025.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Measure current use inside Capillary and publish the number at launch. Call unfinished parts a preview if the outer loop ships first.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Anthropic, 24 Feb 2025; Anthropic Series F, 2 Sep 2025; Every podcast, 29 Oct 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 12.

12 / LAUNCH MECHANICS

12 Vercel: v0's waitlist opened on a fixed date with pricing already set (2023)

WHY IT WORKED

The waitlist produced a demand signal; clear pricing made the opening useful to buyers immediately.

WHAT THEY DID

Vercel built demand for v0 through a waitlist, then opened access with free and paid prices already published.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

More than 100,000 signups in three weeks [third-party], DevClass and SD Times.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Open a qualified design-partner waitlist on 31 October. Publish its count before 19 January and open access with pricing visible.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

DevClass, 10 Oct 2023; SD Times, 18 Dec 2023

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 12.

13 / OPEN SOURCE AS DISTRIBUTION

13 HashiCorp: open-source downloads as the target-account list (2014 to 2021)

WHY IT WORKED

Existing engineering use told sales where to focus and reduced the need for cold outreach.

WHAT THEY DID

HashiCorp offered its core tools as open source and sold enterprise versions to organisations already using them.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 100M downloads in fiscal 2021, used by about 79% of the Fortune 500, 2,101 customers with 558 over \$100K, 124% net dollar retention, 36,000+ user-group members in 140+ chapters [company-reported], S-1 via Meritech. The caution: in August 2023 HashiCorp moved to the Business Source License, and within weeks rivals forked Terraform as OpenTofu under the Linux Foundation [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Open-source one narrow component and prioritise accounts whose engineers use it. Choose a durable licence at launch.

COST

\$349.5M raised to reach about \$300M ARR third-party, Meritech. The licence change cost goodwill and created a competing fork.

SOURCES

HashiCorp S-1, Nov 2021; Meritech, 9 Nov 2021; HashiCorp BSL post, 10 Aug 2023

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 13.

14 / OPEN SOURCE AS DISTRIBUTION

14 Sentry: wrote a licence, named "Fair Source", and started the Open Source Pledge (2023 to 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

A named policy made a restrictive licence easier to explain, while the pledge gave other companies a cause to join.

WHAT THEY DID

Sentry named its source-available position "Fair Source" and paired it with a pledge to fund maintainers.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

100,000 cloud customers and \$100M annual revenue at the Fair Source announcement [company-reported]. The Pledge site shows \$7.4M paid to maintainers in total; members include Zerodha [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

If OneFlux ships source-available code, use an established licence. Consider joining the pledge with a published contribution.

COST

Sentry's own pledge is a \$270,000 a year minimum, and it employs a head of open source company-reported.

SOURCES

Sentry, FSL, 17 Nov 2023; Sentry is now Fair Source, 6 Aug 2024; Open Source Pledge

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 13.

15 / OPEN SOURCE AS DISTRIBUTION

15 Grafana: "big tent", connecting to every data source including competitors' (2022)

WHY IT WORKED

Teams could keep Grafana as their common screen even when the systems behind it changed.

WHAT THEY DID

Grafana connected to competing data stores through plugins and made "big tent" part of its public strategy.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Users configure 16 data sources on average, 24 at companies over 5,000 staff [company-reported]. Over \$400M ARR and 7,000+ customers by September 2025 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Lead with compatibility across Jira, code hosts, incident tools and model providers. Publish the integration count and usage.

COST

Not documented. Maintaining 100+ plugins takes a permanent team inferred.

SOURCES

Grafana, big tent, Jun 2025; Grafana \$400M ARR, 30 Sep 2025; BigDATAwire, 7 Apr 2022

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 14.

16 / OPEN SOURCE AS DISTRIBUTION

16 n8n: self-hosting plus a template library written by users (2022 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Self-hosting addressed security concerns; community templates helped new users find a working starting point.

WHAT THEY DID

n8n combined self-hosting with a public library of user-built workflow templates, each with its own searchable page.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

112,000+ GitHub stars added in 2025, first in JavaScript Rising Stars [third-party]. 6x users and 10x revenue in 2025 [company-reported], via Highland Europe. About \$40M ARR and a \$2.5B valuation at the October 2025 Series C [third-party]. Over 10,000 community templates [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Launch a credited, searchable library of spec templates, review rules and on-call runbooks. Explain VPC and air-gapped options clearly.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

n8n licence post, 17 Mar 2022; Highland Europe, 9 Oct 2025; Wikipedia, n8n

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 14.

17 / OPEN SOURCE AS DISTRIBUTION

17 Temporal: an open-source engine plus a small customer-led conference (2020 to 2023)

WHY IT WORKED

Customer talks served as credible reference stories for other buyers.

WHAT THEY DID

Temporal paired an open-source engine with a small conference where customer engineers showed their own implementations.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Community growing 10 to 15% a month; the first Replay drew 300+ in person [company-reported]. 50,000+ new developers in 2022, and Cloud customers and revenue up 20x in the year after the Series B [third-party], SD Times.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Plan a Bengaluru event led mostly by customer engineering teams showing production agent pipelines.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Temporal, 28 Feb 2023; SD Times, Feb 2023

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 15.

18 / OPEN SOURCE AS DISTRIBUTION

18 GitLab: the public handbook and a free Remote Playbook (2020 to 2021)

WHY IT WORKED

Practical advice attracted readers beyond the product and showed how GitLab itself worked.

WHAT THEY DID

GitLab turned public handbook material into a free Remote Playbook when remote-work guidance was in demand.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Handbook at 10,400 pages in 2021 [company-reported]. About 420K monthly organic visits [third-party] estimate, AirOps. No playbook download numbers published.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish an ungated operating model for agent-assisted engineering, based on Capillary's own practice.

COST

A full-time Head of Remote plus handbook-first discipline.

SOURCES

GitLab press release, 20 Apr 2021; The Lean Startup, 10 Jul 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 15.

19 / CONTENT AND VOICE

19 Stripe: Increment magazine (2017 to 2021)

WHY IT WORKED

It put Stripe in front of senior engineers as a serious infrastructure company, while contributors brought their own audiences.

WHAT THEY DID

Stripe published a themed engineering magazine with outside authors and little product promotion.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

19 issues, 250+ stories, 400+ contributors [company-reported]. No readership or lead numbers were ever published; effect on sales is [inferred].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Consider a digital quarterly on engineering with agents for the April-March plan; print a small run for priority accounts.

COST

A small in-house editorial team (Will Larson names three) plus print production.

SOURCES

Increment, About; Will Larson, 13 Apr 2017

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 16.

20 / CONTENT AND VOICE

20 PostHog: "Product for Engineers", a newsletter about the craft (2023 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Useful writing built a reachable audience of people who may later choose tools.

WHAT THEY DID

PostHog wrote a free newsletter about engineering and product work without making each issue a product pitch.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 38,000 subscribers at the start of 2025 and over 100,000 by the end; posts read over 1M times in 2025 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Start a weekly newsletter for engineering managers and GCC delivery heads before the January launch.

COST

Not documented; one named in-house writer.

SOURCES

PostHog, best of 2025, 22 Dec 2025; PostHog marketing handbook

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 16.

21 / CONTENT AND VOICE

21 Linear: "The Linear Method" (undated)

WHY IT WORKED

Teams could agree with the way of working before evaluating the tool.

WHAT THEY DID

Linear published a clear method for planning and building software, with product choices that matched it.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Over \$100M ARR, 40,000+ paying customers and 177% net retention [third-party], Pulse 2.0, Aug 2026. No metrics for the Method page itself.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish a short method page for agent-assisted development that a GCC leader can use in an internal policy.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Linear Method; Pulse 2.0, 28 Aug 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 17.

22 / CONTENT AND VOICE

22 Fly.io: long Hacker News posts, failures included (2020 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Detailed, candid engineering writing earned attention and trust from developers without much media spend.

WHAT THEY DID

Fly.io used long technical posts with runnable code as its main outreach and wrote openly about reliability failures.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

"Reliability: It's not great" scored 1,226 Hacker News points in March 2023, Fly.io's top post that year; its funding post scored 643 [third-party], Plushcap.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish one engineer-written post each month with real traces, including failures and what the team changed.

COST

Senior engineers' writing time and a slow editing queue company-reported.

SOURCES

Fly.io, A Blog, If You Can Keep It, 15 Feb 2025; Plushcap, Fly.io HN 2023

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 17.

23 / CONTENT AND VOICE

23 Honeycomb: the founder named the category, then gave away an O'Reilly book (2016 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

A strong point of view and a respected book helped the market adopt Honeycomb's definition, then brought in leads.

WHAT THEY DID

Honeycomb's founder argued consistently for "observability" and later co-wrote a book on the subject.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Majors is "widely credited for coining the term observability" in this sense [third-party], TechTarget. Gartner now runs a Magic Quadrant for Observability Platforms [third-party]. No download numbers.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Choose one category phrase and have a named leader defend it regularly. Turn the argument into a concise report for ABM.

COST

Several senior authors' time.

SOURCES

Honeycomb, 10 May 2022; TechTarget, Mar 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 18.

24 / CONTENT AND VOICE

24 Basecamp: Shape Up, with a paid workshop as the prototype for a free book (2019)

WHY IT WORKED

Workshops sharpened the material with buyers; the ungated book let teams spread the method internally.

WHAT THEY DID

Basecamp tested the ideas behind Shape Up in paid workshops, then released the method as a free book.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Singer called the traffic "incredible" and said a Fortune 50 company adopted the method [company-reported]. No readership numbers.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Run two or three "spec with agents" workshops for GCC leaders, then publish an ungated method book at launch.

COST

About a year of a senior product lead's part-time effort. The workshop earned money.

SOURCES

Ryan Singer, How I wrote Shape Up, 22 Aug 2019; 37signals podcast, Nov 2020

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 18.

25 / CONTENT AND VOICE

25 Sourcegraph: a named engineer's thesis essay ahead of the product (2023)

WHY IT WORKED

The essay explained the need for the product in a voice engineers were more likely to read than a launch announcement.

WHAT THEY DID

Sourcegraph published a named engineer's essay on the shift to LLMs before posting about Cody.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

The essay got 405 Hacker News points and 354 comments; the Cody product post got 201 and "Open Sourcing Cody" 105 [third-party], Plushcap.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish a named engineering leader's argument for closing the loop at Spec in early December, ahead of the product post.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Sourcegraph, 23 Mar 2023; Plushcap, Sourcegraph HN 2023

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 19.

26 / CONTENT AND VOICE

26 Sentry: bought the podcast it sponsored and removed the ads (2023)

WHY IT WORKED

Ownership gave Sentry lasting access to the audience; editorial independence protected the show's credibility.

WHAT THEY DID

Sentry bought a podcast it had sponsored, removed third-party ads and left editorial control with the hosts.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 52 sponsored episodes a year before the deal, 600 episodes by the announcement [company-reported]. Price and audience not disclosed.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

For the later plan, sponsor one Indian engineering show or channel for a full year before considering ownership.

COST

Undisclosed price plus at least three roles.

SOURCES

Sentry, 12 Apr 2023; Syntax ep. 892, 9 Apr 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 19.

27 / DEVELOPER EVENTS AND COMMUNITY

27 dbt Labs: Slack first, conference second, and a named job title (2016 to 2022)

WHY IT WORKED

The community supplied support and word of mouth, while the job title gave companies a reason to hire and budget for the work.

WHAT THEY DID

dbt built a practitioner Slack, then meetups and a conference. Its content also helped name the "analytics engineer" role.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Slack grew from 350 to 2,100 members between years two and three [company-reported], Jul 2019. Coalesce 2021 drew 7,000+ practitioners from 2,300+ companies [company-reported]. Analytics-engineer posts in dbt's #jobs channel went from 6% in 2019 to 32% in 2022 [third-party], Metabase.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Start one practitioner channel and bring roundtable attendees in as founding members. Publish a job description for the owner of an agent pipeline.

COST

Not documented. Founders did early support in Slack.

SOURCES

dbt, Three years in, Jul 2019; dbt, What is analytics engineering, 26 Mar 2019; Metabase, 10 Aug 2022

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 20.

28 / DEVELOPER EVENTS AND COMMUNITY

28 Humanitec: PlatformCon and platformengineering.org as a category play (2022 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

People researching platform engineering entered a community Humanitec helped run, including buyers who had not chosen a vendor.

WHAT THEY DID

Humanitec built PlatformCon and platformengineering.org around the category rather than its own product.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Attendance went from 6,000 (2022) to 16,000+ (2023); submissions 105 to 514; Slack 4,000 to 14,000 [company-reported]. 35,000+ viewers in event week 2024 [company-reported]. Gartner Top 10 trend, 16 Oct 2023 [third-party]. New Delhi meetup: 2,260 members [third-party], Meetup.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Submit a 15-minute PlatformCon talk with a design partner. Confirm the San Francisco format before planning around it.

COST

Not documented; 27 sponsors likely offset part of it inferred.

SOURCES

Humanitec, PlatformCon 2023, 20 Jul 2023; Humanitec newsletter vol. 84, 16 Oct 2024; Gartner, 16 Oct 2023; Meetup, Platform Engineers New Delhi

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 20.

29 / DEVELOPER EVENTS AND COMMUNITY

29 Vercel: personalised, shareable Next.js Conf tickets (2019 to 2022)

WHY IT WORKED

A ticket about the attendee gave them a reason to post it, extending the event's reach through their networks.

WHAT THEY DID

Vercel gave conference registrants numbered, personalised tickets designed to be shared online.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Registrations went from 3,888 (2019) to 70,000+ (Oct 2021); 30,000 in one day in 2022 [third-party], swyx. "Almost 40,000 live attendees" in 2020 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Make shareable cards for launch registrants and LinkedIn-ready seat cards for roundtable guests.

COST

In-house design and engineering; not documented.

SOURCES

swyx, Non Fungible Tickets, Sep 2022; Vercel virtual-event-starter-kit

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 21.

30 / DEVELOPER EVENTS AND COMMUNITY

30 swyx and AI Engineer: an essay names the role, an application-only conference sells it (2023 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

The new role gave the event an audience; selective admission made attendance itself a signal.

WHAT THEY DID

An essay named the "AI engineer" role, followed by a small application-only summit and a closed VP track.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

2023: about 400 accepted from 5,000+ applications, about 20,000 livestream viewers [company-reported]. 2024 World's Fair: 3,000+ attendees [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Set a public seat cap for the roundtables, review applications and host a separate VP session.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

AI Engineer, About; Latent Space, World's Fair 2024; Gremlin, Looking back on a day of chaos, 16 Oct 2018

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 21.

31 / DEVELOPER EVENTS AND COMMUNITY

31 MLOps Community: a neutral, sponsor-funded community (2020 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

A neutral host could attract practitioners who would avoid a single vendor's forum.

WHAT THEY DID

MLOps Community grew from calls and Slack into a sponsor-funded, vendor-neutral network.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

31,000 Slack members, 600+ events in 45 cities, 7 virtual conferences with 50,000+ registrants [company-reported], May 2026.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Speak in existing neutral groups in Bengaluru and Delhi rather than trying to build a new community before January.

COST

Sponsor-funded.

SOURCES

MLOps Community 2.0, 13 May 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 22.

32 / PRICING AND PACKAGING

32 GitHub: Copilot free for students and maintainers, then Copilot Free (2022, 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

Free access reached influential developers and future hires; usage limits created a clear upgrade point.

WHAT THEY DID

GitHub made Copilot free for students and selected maintainers, then added a capped free tier for everyone.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

1.2M developers in the technical preview [company-reported]. Over 15M users by May 2025 and 20M by August 2025 [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Give free seats to maintainers and relevant student cohorts. Meter free OneFlux use by runs.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

GitHub, 21 Jun 2022; GitHub, Copilot Free, 18 Dec 2024; iTWire, 1 May 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 23.

33 / PRICING AND PACKAGING

33 Cursor: a \$20 plan engineers can expense, as the way into enterprise (2023 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

Individual adoption created evidence for a later company deal without requiring procurement on day one.

WHAT THEY DID

Cursor's \$20 individual plan let engineers start with an expense report. Enterprise plans followed usage already inside accounts.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

ARR \$100M (Jan 2025), \$500M (Jun 2025), over \$1B (Nov 2025), \$3B (May 2026) [third-party], via Wikipedia citing TechCrunch and Bloomberg.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Offer an expenseable self-serve plan and show account teams where use already exists. Give notice before changing individual terms.

COST

Not documented. The pricing reversal cost goodwill.

SOURCES

Wikipedia, Anysphere; eWeek, 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 23.

34 / PRICING AND PACKAGING

34 Tailscale: a free plan rebuilt around the step from one user to two (2023)

WHY IT WORKED

Growth data showed the second user was the adoption bottleneck, so Tailscale removed that early cost.

WHAT THEY DID

Tailscale expanded its free plan around the hard step from one user to a small team.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

The R0 finding [company-reported], Apr 2023. At its 2025 Series C, business customers were up 20% since January and revenue growth was over 100% a year [company-reported], via Pulse 2.0.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Find OneFlux's equivalent second-user step and make small team use free before procurement begins.

COST

Small-team revenue given up.

SOURCES

Tailscale, Pricing v3, 18 Apr 2023; Pulse 2.0, 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 24.

35 / PRICING AND PACKAGING

35 CodeRabbit: free AI review on every public repo, plus a \$10M pledge (2023 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

Visible reviews demonstrated the product to contributors who also worked at potential customer companies.

WHAT THEY DID

CodeRabbit made reviews free on public repositories and backed open-source use with a public pledge and counter.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 1.7M open-source PRs reviewed, \$1.2M+ cash and \$6.1M+ covered usage since February 2025 [company-reported]. \$15M ARR and 8,000 customers in September 2025 [third-party]. Its site cites a Swiggy case study [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Test a capped free Review offer on public repos and publish a running usage counter.

COST

\$7.3M+ so far against the \$10M pledge company-reported.

SOURCES

CodeRabbit OSS; CodeRabbit open source; ARR.club, 19 Sep 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 24.

36 / PRICING AND PACKAGING

36 Neon: a free tier built for other companies' agents (2024 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Agents became users of the free tier without a human selecting the database provider each time.

WHAT THEY DID

Neon made it easy for other products' agents to create short-lived databases and raised free-plan limits to suit them.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Over 80% of databases provisioned on Neon were created by AI agents, not people [company-reported], Databricks and Neon, 14 May 2025. An earlier 30% figure that circulates could not be found in either source. Databricks bought Neon for about \$1B [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Make OneFlux callable from major coding agents over MCP on a metered free tier, and report the share of agent-triggered runs.

COST

Free-tier infrastructure; not documented.

SOURCES

Databricks, 14 May 2025; Neon, 14 May 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 25.

37 / ENTERPRISE SALES WITH DEVELOPER CREDIBILITY

37 Snyk: developers adopt free, the CISO buys governance (2015 to 2021)

WHY IT WORKED

The daily user and budget owner needed different value: scanning for engineers, policy and reporting for the CISO.

WHAT THEY DID

Snyk first tried charging developers, then sold governance to security leaders while keeping developer use as proof.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 5,000 registered developers by mid-2016; on the paywall, the founder said "We opened the floodgates and got a trickle" [company-reported]. ARR went from \$100K (Aug 2017) to \$4M (2018), \$19M (2019) and \$326M (Feb 2026), though growth slowed to 7% a year [third-party], Sacra.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Turn free usage into a VP or CTO report. Price audit trails, policy and reporting as the governance layer.

COST

A year of failed self-serve monetisation.

SOURCES

Unusual Ventures, 12 Apr 2022; Sacra, Snyk at \$326M ARR; Boldstart, 9 Sep 2021

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 26.

38 / ENTERPRISE SALES WITH DEVELOPER CREDIBILITY

38 Palantir, then OpenAI: forward-deployed engineers as the sales motion (2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Embedded engineers closed the gap between a promising demo and a working deployment, while feeding product gaps back to the vendor.

WHAT THEY DID

Palantir and later OpenAI put engineers inside customer teams to get complex products into production.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

OpenAI had 10+ FDEs across 8 cities in the first year [third-party], Pragmatic Engineer. Implementation-heavy predecessors started with low gross margins and recovered: ServiceNow 63% at IPO to 79% by 2024 [third-party], a16z.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Offer a fixed six-week engineering pod to first ABM accounts and turn each engagement into a reusable playbook.

COST

Lower early gross margin, and engineers pulled from core product.

SOURCES

a16z, Trading Margin for Moat, 4 Jun 2025; Pragmatic Engineer, 12 Aug 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 26.

39 / ENTERPRISE SALES WITH DEVELOPER CREDIBILITY

39 GitLab and AWS: launching off the first Gartner Magic Quadrant for AI Code Assistants (2024)

WHY IT WORKED

A first category report helps procurement decide which vendors belong on the shortlist.

WHAT THEY DID

GitLab and AWS quickly used Leader placements in the first Gartner AI Code Assistants Magic Quadrant in their sales material.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

12 vendors, GitLab and AWS Leaders [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Ask Gartner which evaluations OneFlux can qualify for and when; pursue a realistic mention before launch if an MQ is out of reach.

COST

Reprint licences; amount not public.

SOURCES

GitLab, 22 Aug 2024; AWS, Aug 2024

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 27.

40 / ENTERPRISE SALES WITH DEVELOPER CREDIBILITY

40 Jellyfish: a vendor-owned annual survey for engineering leaders (2020 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

The report gives buyers a quotable gap, collects leads and frames the value of the product.

WHAT THEY DID

Jellyfish publishes an annual engineering-management survey whose headline problem matches what it sells.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Sixth edition, 600+ respondents; 90% of teams (up from 61% a year earlier) use AI coding tools but only 20% measure impact with engineering metrics [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Design the Research NXT survey around a measurable gap OneFlux closes, with separate India GCC and US views.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Jellyfish, 8 Jul 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 27.

41 / ENTERPRISE SALES WITH DEVELOPER CREDIBILITY

41 Puppet, DORA and Google: owning the yardstick (2013 to 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

The owner of a trusted yardstick shapes the questions buyers ask vendors. Publishing unwelcome findings protects that trust.

WHAT THEY DID

Puppet helped establish the State of DevOps research that became DORA's widely used delivery metrics.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

2024 report: a 25% rise in AI adoption is associated with +7.5% documentation quality, +3.1% review speed, but -1.5% delivery throughput and -7.2% delivery stability [company-reported], Google. Nine paying gold sponsors on the 2024 report [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Map OneFlux results to DORA's four keys and use its stability findings to frame Review and On-call.

COST

Acquisition price undisclosed.

SOURCES

DORA joins Google Cloud, 20 Dec 2018; Google Cloud, 2024 DORA report, 23 Oct 2024

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 28.

42 / PROOF, BENCHMARKS AND PUBLIC FAILURE

42 GitHub: a randomised trial as Copilot's launch number (2022, 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

A measured effect with a published method gave press a memorable number and buyers a stronger budget case.

WHAT THEY DID

GitHub used a randomised developer trial for Copilot's speed claim, then studied use in a named enterprise.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

1h11m against 2h41m, $p=.0017$, 95% CI 21% to 89% [company-reported]. Accenture: +8.69% pull requests, +15% merge rate, +84% successful builds [company-reported]. Counter-evidence: METR's 2025 trial found experienced developers 19% slower with AI while believing they were 20% faster [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Run a small randomised study with a design partner. Publish the method, interval and measures beyond code written.

COST

Research team time and paid participants.

SOURCES

GitHub, 7 Sep 2022; GitHub and Accenture, 13 May 2024; METR, 10 Jul 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 29.

43 / PROOF, BENCHMARKS AND PUBLIC FAILURE

43 Augment Code: #1 on SWE-bench Verified, with the benchmark's limits in the same post (2025)

WHY IT WORKED

The headline drew attention; candid limits gave sceptical engineers more reason to trust the result.

WHAT THEY DID

Augment posted a leading SWE-bench Verified score, opened its pipeline and stated the benchmark's limits in the same post.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

65.4% [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Put "what this does not measure" beside every OneFlux score and test on enterprise-sized, multi-language repos.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Augment Code, 31 Mar 2025; OpenAI, SWE-bench Verified, 13 Aug 2024

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 29.

44 / PROOF, BENCHMARKS AND PUBLIC FAILURE

44 Greptile: a benchmark that names every competitor (2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Public cases and explicit scoring gave buyers a comparison they could check.

WHAT THEY DID

Greptile compared AI review tools on public bugs, named each rival and defined what counted as a correct catch.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Greptile 82%, Cursor Bugbot 58%, Copilot 54%, CodeRabbit 44%, Graphite 6% [company-reported], Jul 2025. It doesn't say who ran the evaluation [inferred].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish a reproducible benchmark for an undermeasured task such as incident triage, and disclose who ran it.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Greptile benchmarks, Jul 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 30.

45 / PROOF, BENCHMARKS AND PUBLIC FAILURE

45 Bun: a 1.0 post built as a wall of head-to-head benchmarks (2023)

WHY IT WORKED

Specific, checkable comparisons made a broad launch easier to understand and repeat.

WHAT THEY DID

Bun's 1.0 launch compared each part of its toolchain with the named product developers already used.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Tests 13x faster than Jest, bundling 220x faster than webpack, among others [company-reported]. A Node.js core contributor confirmed the install speed but disputed "drop-in replacement" [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Give each OneFlux module one measured comparison with the current workflow, and state compatibility limits precisely.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Bun 1.0, 8 Sep 2023; Matteo Collina, 11 Sep 2023; Cloudflare, 2 Jul 2018

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 30.

46 / PROOF, BENCHMARKS AND PUBLIC FAILURE

46 GitLab: livestreamed its own database-loss recovery (2017)

WHY IT WORKED

Watching engineers solve the problem made the failure transparent and credible to developers.

WHAT THEY DID

GitLab made its recovery notes and call public after a production database deletion, then published a full postmortem.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 5,000 concurrent viewers, YouTube's #2 live stream for hours [company-reported]. About 5,000 projects, 5,000 comments and 700 accounts lost over about 18 hours [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Set a policy to publish the On-call agent's incident timeline and reasoning, including mistakes, after a real incident.

COST

The outage and lost data. No marketing spend.

SOURCES

GitLab postmortem, 10 Feb 2017; Increment, Apr 2017

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 31.

47 / PROOF, BENCHMARKS AND PUBLIC FAILURE

47 Cloudflare: same-day, code-level post-mortems (2019 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Specific explanations show infrastructure buyers that the vendor understands and owns its failures.

WHAT THEY DID

Cloudflare publishes fast, technical postmortems with code and timelines after major outages.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 5.5 hours of significant impact, post published the same day [company-reported]. Infosecurity Magazine cited it as how trust is earned [third-party]. No figure links post-mortems to retention.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Commit to a customer-visible postmortem within 24 hours and use OneFlux On-call to help produce it.

COST

Senior executive time on the worst day.

SOURCES

Cloudflare, 18 Nov 2025; Infosecurity Magazine, 23 Jul 2019

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 31.

48 / MARKETPLACES AND PARTNER CHANNELS

48 CrowdStrike and Datadog: billing against the cloud spend the buyer already committed (2018 to 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

Existing cloud commitments and partner routes made purchases easier to fund and process.

WHAT THEY DID

CrowdStrike and Datadog sold through cloud marketplaces and billing relationships buyers had already approved.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

CrowdStrike sold \$1B+ through AWS Marketplace in calendar 2024 alone, and says marketplace deals average 4x larger [company-reported]. 48% of buyers in Tackle's survey say drawing down committed spend is their top reason to buy through a marketplace [third-party]. AWS Marketplace opened INR invoicing and India-based sellers on 6 Nov 2025, naming TCS and Swiggy as buyers [company-reported]. Datadog's Azure integration counts toward the Azure commitment [company-reported], Microsoft Learn; no adoption figures published.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Make OneFlux transactable on AWS Marketplace by 19 January with private offers, including INR; plan Azure eligibility next.

COST

Listing fees and a partner-alliances hire unverified; Datadog's was joint engineering with Microsoft.

SOURCES

Channellife, 27 Feb 2025; CrowdStrike via BusinessWire, 26 Feb 2025; Tackle, 20 Jul 2023; Amazon, AWS Marketplace in India, 6 Nov 2025; Datadog, Azure partnership, 2020 to 2021; Microsoft Learn, Datadog on Azure

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 32.

49 / MARKETPLACES AND PARTNER CHANNELS

49 Atlassian Marketplace: the app that lives where the tickets are (2012 to 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

Customers can add an app through a familiar purchasing path, while solution partners can recommend it during implementation.

WHAT THEY DID

Atlassian's marketplace puts partner apps inside Jira and Confluence administration and billing.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

\$4B in lifetime Marketplace sales by January 2024; the first billion took about eight years and the fourth just over one [company-reported]. 1,800+ vendors, 5,700+ apps, about 20,000 installs a week [company-reported], Apr 2024. Over 70% of Jira and Confluence Cloud customers had at least one app in 2021 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Build a Forge app that turns a Jira epic into a OneFlux spec, then equip Atlassian partners to recommend it.

COST

Atlassian's revenue share; vendor costs not documented.

SOURCES

Atlassian, 26 Apr 2024; Atlassian, 9 Dec 2021

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 33.

50 / MARKETPLACES AND PARTNER CHANNELS

50 Infosys and Cognizant: the systems integrator as customer zero and channel (2024 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Systems integrators bring trained people and their own usage evidence into accounts they already serve.

WHAT THEY DID

Infosys used Copilot internally before selling it to clients; Cognizant paired a large Claude rollout with client offers.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

18,000+ Infosys developers on Copilot and 7M+ lines of Copilot code by October 2024 [company-reported]. Cognizant is one of Anthropic's three largest enterprise customers [third-party], Computerworld. The hackathon drew 53,199 active participants in 40 countries and holds a Guinness record [company-reported]; [third-party], Guinness.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Sign one Indian SI as customer zero before 19 January, with partner pricing, co-published usage and sellable playbooks.

COST

Deal values not disclosed.

SOURCES

Infosys and Microsoft, 9 Oct 2024; Anthropic, Cognizant partnership, 4 Nov 2025; Computerworld, 5 Nov 2025; Cognizant newsroom, 21 Aug 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 33.

51 / MARKETPLACES AND PARTNER CHANNELS

51 Upstash: Context7, a free MCP server that markets a database company (2025 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

It solved a common agent problem and placed Upstash's name inside other companies' workflows.

WHAT THEY DID

Upstash released Context7, a free MCP server that puts current library docs inside coding agents.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

62.7K GitHub stars and 3.1K forks [third-party], GitHub, Oct 2026. GitHub launched its MCP Registry with one-click VS Code install on 16 Sep 2025 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Release one free MCP server for a narrow job, such as supplying architecture decisions to any coding agent, before December.

COST

Upstash team time; not documented.

SOURCES

Upstash, 11 Apr 2025; upstash/context7; GitHub MCP Registry, 16 Sep 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 34.

52 / PRODUCT GROWTH LOOPS

52 Statuspage: a "Powered by Statuspage" footer on every customer's page (2013 to 2016, still live)

WHY IT WORKED

Outages drew the precise audience that might buy a status product, giving each page a relevant referral path.

WHAT THEY DID

Statuspage kept a small "Powered by" link on customers' public status pages, including paid accounts.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

The badge drove 30 to 40% of new customer acquisition, and fewer than 10 of about 1,500 paying accounts asked to remove it [company-reported], founder in a podcast interview, not audited. Atlassian acquired Statuspage in July 2016 [third-party], TechCrunch.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Add default, switchable attribution to incident summaries and post-incident pages written by OneFlux On-call.

COST

Close to zero engineering. The risk of annoying customers didn't materialise.

SOURCES

SaaS Podcast ep. 87, Scott Klein; TechCrunch, 14 Jul 2016; githubstatus.com

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 35.

53 / PRODUCT GROWTH LOOPS

53 Anthropic: Claude Code's default co-author trailer and PR footer (2025 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

The credit stays in repository history, making use visible across teams and measurable from outside public repos.

WHAT THEY DID

Claude Code adds a co-author trailer to commits and an attribution footer to pull requests by default, with an opt-out.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

SemiAnalysis estimated Claude Code authors about 4% of public GitHub commits [third-party], via Xataka, Feb 2026. Amplifying tracks a 91.6% merge rate across 4.6M+ attributed PRs, Jul to Sep 2026 [third-party]. Renovate had 1M+ PRs by November 2019; Dependabot passed 1M merged PRs by July 2019 [company-reported]. Counts are a floor, since users can turn attribution off [inferred].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Add a default co-author trailer and PR footer linking to the source spec, with an admin switch.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

ClaudeLog, attribution setting; Xataka, 6 Feb 2026; Amplifying, Claude Code; Mend, 13 Nov 2019; GitHub, 25 Jul 2019

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 36.

54 / PRODUCT GROWTH LOOPS

54 Vercel and Netlify: preview links that bring non-developers into the product (2016, 2022)

WHY IT WORKED

A working preview travels beyond the developer team, and commenting gives new stakeholders a reason to sign in.

WHAT THEY DID

Vercel and Netlify put preview links on pull requests; Vercel then added comments for non-developers.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Companies ramp from an occasional thread to about 100 comments a day around launches [company-reported], Vercel CTO via TechCrunch, Dec 2022. Netlify lists Deploy Previews as a milestone on its road to 1M developers [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Give each spec and review a shareable link that stakeholders can read without a seat and comment on after sign-in.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Vercel, 22 Sep 2022; TechCrunch, 20 Dec 2022; Netlify milestones, 3 Aug 2020

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 36.

55 / PRODUCT GROWTH LOOPS

55 Postman, Netlify and StackBlitz: buttons and embeds in other people's docs (2016 to 2024)

WHY IT WORKED

The host site improved its own onboarding, while users entered the tool behind the button.

WHAT THEY DID

Postman, Netlify and StackBlitz placed useful buttons or runnable embeds in other organisations' docs.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Postman's network served 17M users and 500,000 organisations in August 2021 [company-reported]. An outside count found about 232,000 backlinks to Netlify's deploy flow, roughly half from GitHub [third-party], Apr 2021. StackBlitz tutorials reach 500,000+ unique learners a month [company-reported], Jul 2024.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Publish forkable reference specs and a "Fork into OneFlux" button for partner docs and GCC onboarding material.

COST

Small features; not documented.

SOURCES

Postman, Run in Postman; Help Net Security, 10 Aug 2021; Netlify, 29 Nov 2016; Scott Mathson, 9 Apr 2021; StackBlitz, 25 Jul 2024

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 37.

56 / EDUCATION AND INDIA PROGRAMMES

56 Microsoft: AI Odyssey, a one-month credential sprint for Indian developers (2024)

WHY IT WORKED

A deadline, verifiable credential and scarce event seat made self-paced study more likely to finish.

WHAT THEY DID

Microsoft India ran a short, free AI learning sprint ending in a lab credential and a chance to attend a flagship event.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

100,000 developers in India "enabled" in January 2024 [company-reported]. Phase 2 across Asia targeted 150,000 more [company-reported], target. The Bengaluru AI Tour drew 1,100 developers and technology leaders [company-reported]. GitHub's Octoverse projects India at 57.5M developers by 2030 against 54.7M in the US [third-party], The Register.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Run a four-week OneFlux sprint across all four modules, with lab assessment and Bengaluru launch seats for finishers.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Microsoft India, 8 Jan 2024; Microsoft India, Feb 2024; The Register, 29 Oct 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 38.

57 / EDUCATION AND INDIA PROGRAMMES

57 CNCF: Kubestronaut, a named title for holding all five certifications (2024 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

A title and physical badge made multiple exams worth completing and sharing, including in country-level rankings.

WHAT THEY DID

CNCF made completion of five Kubernetes certifications a named "Kubestronaut" identity with visible rewards.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

500+ Kubestronauts by August 2024 with India first; about 2,000 across 97 countries by August 2025 with India top at 180; 3,500+ by March 2026 [company-reported]. In CNCF's survey 37% said the certifications helped them get a job [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Create one title for engineers certified on all four modules, with a public country count and a physical reward.

COST

Jackets and coupons; not otherwise documented.

SOURCES

CNCF, 27 Aug 2024; CNCF, Aug 2025; CNCF, 23 Mar 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 38.

58 / EDUCATION AND INDIA PROGRAMMES

58 MongoDB: an India student pipeline through government channels (2023 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

Institutional channels opened many campuses at once and connected training to projects and enterprise hiring.

WHAT THEY DID

MongoDB expanded India training through colleges, AICTE and virtual internships; Snowflake used Nasscom FutureSkills Prime.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

650,000+ students trained by June 2026, past the original goal [company-reported]. 100,000+ students and 200+ institutions after year one [company-reported]. Snowflake aims to enrol 100,000 Indian learners in two years [company-reported], target.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Pilot a free agentic SDLC course with Nasscom and the colleges that supply target GCCs.

COST

Fellowships up to \$50,000 each; programme budget not documented. Snowflake's global programme is \$20M company-reported.

SOURCES

MongoDB, 12 Sep 2023; MongoDB, 12 Sep 2024; MongoDB, 30 Jun 2026; The Week (PTI), 21 Mar 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 39.

59 / EDUCATION AND INDIA PROGRAMMES

59 WeMakeDevs: sponsored tracks in a creator-run hackathon (2023 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

The creator supplied a trusted audience; entering the track gave participants a reason to try the sponsor's API.

WHAT THEY DID

WeMakeDevs let sponsors fund hackathon tracks judged on use of their technology.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

5,500+ participants and 7,000+ API signups for the Cerebras hackathon [company-reported], by WeMakeDevs, not independently verified. Community of 200K+ members [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Sponsor one December track requiring Review or On-call, with a partner GCC interview as the prize and tracked keys for measurement.

COST

About \$5,000 per sponsor track in prizes; sponsorship fees not documented.

SOURCES

WeMakeDevs; FutureStack GenAI, 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 39.

60 / EDUCATION AND INDIA PROGRAMMES

60 Codeium (Windsurf): a free, vendor-taught DeepLearning.AI course (2025)

WHY IT WORKED

The course reached learners through a trusted education brand and taught a skill rather than pitching a product.

WHAT THEY DID

Codeium taught a free Windsurf course through DeepLearning.AI under a broad agent-building topic.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

DeepLearning.AI has 10M+ learners and 150+ courses [company-reported]. Enrolment for this course isn't published [unverified].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Pitch a DeepLearning.AI course on spec-driven development with agents, taught by a OneFlux engineer, for 2027.

COST

No fee either way, per Ng; the vendor supplies a senior instructor and content.

SOURCES

DeepLearning.AI course; Andrew Ng, The Batch, 3 Jul 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 40.

61 / EDUCATION AND INDIA PROGRAMMES

61 Cursor: volunteer ambassadors, an India roadshow, then a rupee plan (2025 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

The community filled the rooms; local payment and pricing answered a visible buyer request.

WHAT THEY DID

Cursor built local ambassador meetups before an India roadshow and then launched a rupee-priced, UPI-payable plan.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

800+ events in 250+ cities, 300+ Ambassadors [company-reported]. India users tripled in a year to 3M+ developers, Cursor's third-largest market [company-reported]. A Hyderabad meetup drew 205 attendees [company-reported], Luma.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Recruit 10-20 GCC champions, fund meetups in key cities and reveal an India-specific offer at the roundtables.

COST

Meetup funding and stickers; not documented.

SOURCES

Cursor Ambassadors; Cursor, Cursor Start India, 28 Jul 2026; The Next Web, Jul 2026; Luma, Cursor India Roadshow Hyderabad

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 40.

62 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

62 MongoDB and Snowflake: voucher-only events across three Indian cities in ten days (2022 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

Voucher codes made the event a step in named-account sales; one travelling team reused the programme across cities.

WHAT THEY DID

MongoDB and Snowflake ran closely spaced events in major Indian cities, with account teams controlling invitations and local customers speaking.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

18 cities on the 2024 tour [company-reported]. MongoDB has about 700 staff in India [third-party], Entrepreneur India. For contrast, Snowflake's open-registration Sydney stop saw about half of its 4,000+ registrants attend [third-party], InterWorks.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Make roundtables voucher-only, issue codes per target GCC and book a local customer speaker in each city.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

MongoDB, 2024.local world tour; MongoDB.local Bengaluru FAQ; CXOToday, Sep 2022; Entrepreneur India, 2 Jul 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 41.

63 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

63 Confluent: Kafka Summit renamed for the category, then taken to Bengaluru (2016 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

A category name welcomed buyers beyond existing product users; local scale stories made the event credible.

WHAT THEY DID

Confluent widened Kafka Summit into a data-streaming event and brought the format to Bengaluru with Indian engineering speakers.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Bengaluru 2024 had 2,500+ participants, in person and online [company-reported]. Current Bengaluru 2025 listed 3,500+ attendees [third-party], in a promotional-style article. PhonePe runs about 400 billion messages a day [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Name roundtables for agentic SDLC rather than OneFlux and lead each city with a local engineering case.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Confluent, Introducing Current, 25 Apr 2022; Confluent, Kafka Summit Bangalore 2024 recap; Analytics India Magazine, 3 Jul 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 41.

64 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

64 LeadDev: renting a room of VPs of Engineering (ongoing)

WHY IT WORKED

A neutral facilitator can gather senior buyers and make the discussion useful after the event.

WHAT THEY DID

LeadDev hosts small, private VP Engineering roundtables for sponsors and publishes anonymised takeaways.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 15 per roundtable; 5,000+ event attendees a year across London, New York and Berlin; 86% of the audience have budget influence [company-reported]. No sponsor pipeline data published.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Book one US roundtable before PlatformCon and use the write-up to invite attendees to the San Francisco dinner.

COST

Not public.

SOURCES

LeadDev roundtable FAQs; LeadDev, plan your next campaign

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 42.

65 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

65 Reo.dev and Common Room: telling sales which accounts' engineers are already active (2023 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Engineers often test tools before a VP engages; these signals help sales focus on active accounts.

WHAT THEY DID

Reo.dev and Common Room turn developer activity across docs, GitHub and other surfaces into account signals.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

DataHub reported \$1.01M of pipeline in a quarter from Reo.dev-identified accounts [company-reported], via press snippet. With Common Room, Apollo GraphQL got 26% of qualified leads in a quarter and Pulumi 27% of meetings booked [company-reported], vendor case studies. Reo.dev raised an \$11.3M Series A [third-party].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Instrument OneFlux's docs, CLI and repos, then rank GCCs by activity for roundtable invites and ABM outreach.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

GlobeNewswire, Reo.Dev seed, 8 Oct 2025; Common Room, Apollo GraphQL; Common Room, Pulumi

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 42.

66 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

66 GitHub: a commissioned Forrester Total Economic Impact study as the CFO slide (2022 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

An analyst-branded model gives finance a familiar format for judging ROI, despite its assumptions.

WHAT THEY DID

GitHub commissioned Forrester to model Enterprise Cloud ROI from a small interview sample and a composite company.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

376% ROI, \$67.9M NPV and payback under six months for the composite, July 2025 [company-reported], vendor-commissioned. \$48.3M of the benefit rests on a claim of saving developers about half their coding time [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Recruit four or five design partners for a 2027 value study, split benefits by module and test sensitivity to major claims.

COST

Not documented. The sample is small.

SOURCES

Forrester TEI, GitHub Enterprise Cloud, Jul 2025; GitHub, 20 Dec 2022

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 43.

67 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

67 Atlassian, GitHub, Snowflake and Pulumi: takeout packages built around a deadline (2023 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

A deadline creates urgency; people and credits reduce the cost and risk of switching.

WHAT THEY DID

Atlassian, GitHub, Snowflake and Pulumi paired migration offers with deadlines, named help or credits.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

Atlassian Data Center to cloud migrations more than doubled year on year in Q1 FY26, and nearly half a million users went through FastShift's pilot [company-reported]. SnowConvert automates over 96% of code conversion [company-reported]. No published outcomes for GitHub's or Pulumi's counter-moves.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Offer a named rollout team to large GCC pilots that provide an executive sponsor and weekly check-ins. Keep contract credits ready for pricing-driven takeouts.

COST

FastShift is included with cloud purchase; other costs not documented.

SOURCES

Atlassian, 12 Sep 2023; Atlassian, What is FastShift; Atlassian Q1 FY26 letter; GitHub, 17 Oct 2023; Snowflake, 28 Jan 2025; Pulumi, 18 Dec 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 43.

68 / FIELD MARKETING AND ENTERPRISE PROGRAMMES

68 MongoDB: AMP, selling modernisation as tool plus method plus engineers (2024 to 2025)

WHY IT WORKED

Enterprise buyers could fund a bounded project with someone accountable for the outcome.

WHAT THEY DID

MongoDB packaged AI migration tools with a delivery method and named engineers under AMP.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

More than 50% lower modernisation cost in pilots [company-reported], earnings call. Bendigo Bank cut a test run from 80+ hours to 5 minutes; Lombard Odier cut regression testing from 3 days to 3 hours [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Launch one priced GCC modernisation package with OneFlux agents, a six-week method and named engineers, backed by a design-partner result.

COST

Priced per engagement; not documented.

SOURCES

MongoDB, AMP launch, 16 Sep 2025; Motley Fool, Q3 FY25 call, 9 Dec 2024

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 44.

69 / BRAND, DATES AND STANDARDS

69 Cloudflare: a launch date that matches the product, then a waitlist on the anniversary (2018, 2019)

WHY IT WORKED

The memorable date helped the story travel, while performance and privacy evidence supported the claim.

WHAT THEY DID

Cloudflare tied the 1.1.1.1 launch to 1 April and returned on the anniversary with a WARP waitlist.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

About 14ms average response against 34.51ms for Google, per the independent DNSPerf monitor [company-reported], citing [third-party]. About 2 million people joined the WARP waitlist [company-reported]. 1.1.1.1 handles 1.9 trillion queries a day as of February 2025 [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Give 19 January a repeatable reason and use the anniversary for a later release. If announcing an unfinished feature, show a clear waitlist.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

Cloudflare, Announcing 1.1.1.1, 1 Apr 2018; Cloudflare, WARP, 25 Sep 2019; Cloudflare Radar, 27 Feb 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 45.

70 / BRAND, DATES AND STANDARDS

70 GitHub: the Arctic Code Vault and a badge for every contributor (2019 to 2020)

WHY IT WORKED

The badge made a broad brand programme personal, giving developers a reason to share it.

WHAT THEY DID

GitHub archived public code in the Arctic and gave every included contributor a profile badge.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

21TB on 186 reels [company-reported]. No count of badge shares found.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Give early OneFlux users a dated, verifiable credential tied to real shipped specs and suitable for LinkedIn.

COST

Not documented; about seven months from announcement to deposit.

SOURCES

GitHub, 16 Jul 2020; GitHub Archive Program

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 45.

71 / BRAND, DATES AND STANDARDS

71 Anthropic: the "Zero Slop Zone" pop-up and its "thinking" cap, with PostHog's merch bill as the guardrail (2025 to 2026)

WHY IT WORKED

The item carried the campaign message and the app check linked giveaways to installs, but the economics depend on an existing audience.

WHAT THEY DID

Anthropic paired a one-week newsstand pop-up with simple "thinking" merch and an app check; PostHog later disclosed the high cost of merch.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

5,000+ visitors and 10M+ social impressions [third-party], The Decoder and Adweek. PostHog spends about \$60K a month and 1.5 people on merch, with revenue "not enough to even mention", and once paid \$62.54 to ship a \$1 sticker to India [company-reported].

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

If running a Bengaluru or Hyderabad pop-up, make it event-only, tie it to a workspace sign-up and cap the merch budget.

COST

The pop-up's cost isn't disclosed; the campaign was "multi-million dollar" third-party.

SOURCES

The Decoder, Oct 2025; Axios, 18 Sep 2025; PostHog, 25 Aug 2026

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 46.

72 / BRAND, DATES AND STANDARDS

72 OpenAI and peers: AGENTS.md, a neutral file name as a standard (2025)

WHY IT WORKED

A vendor-neutral format is easier for rivals and enterprises to adopt, and each repo exposes it to more developers.

WHAT THEY DID

OpenAI released AGENTS.md under a neutral name with other vendors, then moved it to foundation stewardship.

EVIDENCE AND LIMITS

20,000+ repositories by late August 2025 [third-party], InfoQ; 60,000+ open-source projects by December 2025 [company-reported], Linux Foundation.

ONEFLUX APPLICATION

Read AGENTS.md natively and propose a small neutral format for a spec or on-call handoff that teams can adopt without buying OneFlux.

COST

Not documented.

SOURCES

agents.md; InfoQ, 27 Aug 2025; Linux Foundation, 9 Dec 2025

Edited summary. Full case: original research, page 46.

Research archive

The next seven pages reproduce the source file's discarded-candidates appendix. They remain in their original table layout so candidate names, numbers, evidence labels and reasons are preserved exactly.

The appendix records ideas cut for fit, missing outcomes, weak sources or overlap with stronger examples. A discarded candidate is not automatically a bad idea.

Appendix: what was discarded

Two research passes on 6 Oct 2026 looked at about 180 candidates. This appendix lists everything that didn't become an entry, so nothing has to be searched for twice. Numbers carry the same evidence tags as the main file; anything seen only in a search-result snippet is marked unverified. A candidate here isn't a bad idea. It failed one of four tests: a primary source, a documented outcome, a fit with an enterprise AI SDLC launch, or not repeating a stronger entry.

A. Sourced, but cut for fit

These had real numbers. They were cut because they suit a consumer or self-serve product, can't be planned, or a stronger entry already makes the point. Any could come back if the plan changes.

CANDIDATE	WHAT IT WAS	WHAT WAS FOUND	WHY IT WAS CUT	SOURCE
Supabase tagline (2020)	Homepage changed from "real-time Postgres" to "the open source Firebase alternative", then posted to Hacker News under that line	Hosted databases went from 8 to 800 in three days; the HN post got 1,100+ upvotes; 3K+ databases and about 5.5K stars by July 2020 third-party, Contrary	Naming the incumbent works best for a self-serve product with one obvious rival; OneFlux replaces several tools	Contrary Research, Aug 2024
BrowserStack word of mouth (2011 to 2018)	Mumbai founders posted where developers complained; jQuery's creator tweeted about it; no outside money or sales team for seven years	About 10,000 beta users in three weeks and 1,000 paying customers in six months; \$20M ARR in four years with about 50 people third-party . 25,000+ paying customers and 1.6M+ developers by 2018 third-party, TechCrunch	A lucky endorsement can't be planned; the lesson survives as entry 61's champions	TechCrunch, 30 Jan 2018
DigitalOcean Hacktoberfest (2014 to 2023)	October open-source month with community meetups and a t-shirt for finishers	India hosted 213 of 673 in-person events in 2019, Bengaluru first. Registrations fell from 146,891 (2022) to 98,855 (2023) after the t-shirt was dropped company-reported	Rewards open-source contribution, which OneFlux doesn't sell. Keep the lesson: any community month needs its reward budgeted from the start	DigitalOcean, 12 Nov 2019 ; DigitalOcean, 15 Nov 2023
Bolt.new (2024)	StackBlitz launched a prompt-to-app tool with a single tweet on 3 Oct 2024	\$0 to \$40M ARR in about five months with fewer than 40 staff third-party, Growth Unhinged	Consumer and prosumer audience; too close to Lovable	Growth Unhinged, 9 Jul 2025
Lovable ARR posts (2024 to 2025)	The CEO posted each revenue milestone and paired the \$100M post with a product launch	\$100M ARR at eight months, 2.3M active users, 180K paying, 45 staff third-party, TechCrunch	Enterprise buyers weigh ARR less. A usage number on a fixed cadence (specs merged, incidents closed) fits OneFlux better	TechCrunch, 23 Jul 2025
Lovable badge and Linkable (2024 to 2025)	"Edit with Lovable" badge on free-plan apps; a \$2 LinkedIn-to-website generator built with Lovable	About 20,000 Linkable sites in a few days unverified	Consumer audience; entries 52 and 53 make the attribution point for engineering buyers	Luca Mastella, 8 Apr 2025

CANDIDATE	WHAT IT WAS	WHAT WAS FOUND	WHY IT WAS CUT	SOURCE
GitKraken buys GitLens and a Jira app (2021 to 2022)	Bought the top free VS Code Git extension and the top paid Git app on the Atlassian Marketplace	GitLens had 11M active users and 71M downloads; the Jira app was used by 10,000+ companies company-reported . GitLens shows 53.1M installs third-party	Buying distribution isn't open to OneFlux before launch. Partnering with the top extension next to spec writing or review still is	Newswire , 8 Oct 2021; Resurgens , 16 Feb 2022
Supabase on the Vercel Marketplace (2024)	First-party integration: create a Supabase database from Vercel, billed by Vercel	Provisioning under 60 seconds; became Supabase's "largest partner channel" within weeks, no figures company-reported	Entries 48 and 49 make the "buy through the bill they already pay" point for enterprise	Supabase , 28 Aug 2024; Vercel , 7 Oct 2024
Datadog land and expand	Selling more products into existing accounts	55% of customers on four or more products by Q4 2025; net retention around 120% unverified, no primary source fetched	A product and pricing motion, not a marketing move	None kept
Tailscale bottom-up spread	Personal free use spreading into companies	5,000+ paying customers by March 2024, more than half added in the prior year unverified	Entry 34 covers the mechanism with a primary source	None kept
Supabase free tier	Generous free databases	1M+ databases and 2,500+ new a day in April 2024 unverified, snippets only	Entry 36 (Neon) makes the agent-provisioning point with a primary source	None kept
Postman State of the API	Annual open-access survey	Seventh edition in 2025, 5,700+ respondents company-reported	Same mechanism as entry 40, whose audience is closer to OneFlux's buyer	None kept
Stack Overflow developer survey	Survey sponsorship	2024: 65,000+ respondents; 76% using or planning to use AI; 43% trust its accuracy third-party	Sponsorship terms aren't public; useful as data, not as a move	None kept
Kubernetes the Hard Way	Kelsey Hightower's step-by-step tutorial repo	50,302 GitHub stars third-party, GitHub API	An individual Googler's project and widely known	None kept
Retool State of Internal Tools	Vendor survey	310 respondents in 2020 company-reported	Small sample and well known; entry 40 covers the pattern	None kept
Neo4j GraphAcademy	Free courses	200K learners company-reported	Nothing links it to adoption or revenue	None kept
ETHIndia and Devfolio	India hackathon platform	450+ projects in 2022; 950K builders across the platform company-reported	Crypto-specific audience	None kept
Databricks Data + AI World Tour	City roadshow	22 cities and 22,000+ attendees in 2025; 20 cities and 40,000+ expected in 2026 company-reported	No detail found on the executive-forum format; entry 62 covers city roadshows	None kept
Raycast	Product Hunt launch and extension store	#8 on Product Hunt in October 2020; 300 developers and 500+ extensions unverified	An ecosystem story, not a launch move	None kept
Arc browser	Invite-only waitlist	Waitlist dropped at 1.0 in July 2023; 500K+ on the Windows waitlist third-party, TechCrunch	No primary source on how the waitlist worked; used as a comparison in entry 12	TechCrunch , 11 Dec 2023
Codeium free extension	Free-forever individual tier in VS Code and JetBrains	1M, then 3M downloads company-reported	Its blog now sits under Cognition, and GitKraken covered the extension route	None kept

CANDIDATE	WHAT IT WAS	WHAT WAS FOUND	WHY IT WAS CUT	SOURCE
AWS Marketplace "AI Agents and Tools"	New category launched July 2025	900+ listings company-reported	No vendor outcomes yet; worth listing in, per entry 48	None kept
Cursor's early ARR	Growth before the enterprise push	\$4M in April 2024 to \$48M in October 2024 third-party, TechCrunch	The "no marketing, demo loop on X" story behind it has no primary source	None kept
GitHub Wrapped-style recaps	Graphite "Year in Code" and Remotion "GitHub Unwrapped" (Dec 2023)	Both real; the only number found was Rubric's 2021 GitHub Wrapped "scaled to 10k users" unverified	No usage figures for the 2023 versions	None kept

B. Real moves with no documented outcome

The move exists and was confirmed, but nothing showed what it achieved.

CANDIDATE	WHAT WAS CONFIRMED	WHY IT WAS CUT
Oxide Computer podcasts	"On the Metal" began late 2019; "Oxide and Friends" began as a Twitter Space on 3 May 2021 and passed 100 episodes by January 2024	No audience, customer or hiring outcome found
Honeycomb's o11ycon (2018)	A primary recap exists on dev.to	No attendance or business numbers
Datadog DASH	1,400+ workshops and sponsor counts published company-reported	No total attendance; thin mechanism
Datadog Summits	Customer-led city summits in London, Tokyo, Paris and Berlin	No numbers
HashiConf, GitHub Universe	Both run every year	Large first-party conferences without a mechanism a launch-stage team can copy; dbt and PlatformCon cover the pattern
Vercel Ship	Yearly conference: New York 2024, June 2025, five cities in 2026	No attendance figures or launch mechanics
OpenAI Codex launch	A livestream on 16 May 2025 and access staged by plan tier	No outcome numbers
Statsig SF billboards (2024)	200+ placements and the copy are documented	No results
Kilo Code SF billboard (Nov 2025)	The billboard ran	No placements, cost or results
Cloudflare Birthday Week, R2 (2021)	Launch confirmed	No waitlist or adoption numbers
Snowflake Partner Connect	Mechanism confirmed	No adoption number
Claude Integrations launch partners (May 2025)	Atlassian, Sentry, Linear and Cloudflare co-launched	No partner-side numbers
Turso and ThePrimeagen (Jan 2024)	A "fly Prime to Brazil" goal of 100 annual-plan signups through a tracked link	Outcome never published

CANDIDATE	WHAT WAS CONFIRMED	WHY IT WAS CUT
Creator sponsorships (Theo, Fireship, ThePrimeagen)	Sponsor lists and third-party rate estimates, such as \$3.5K to \$7.1K per video for Theo third-party, sponsorradar	No documented outcomes
Indian creators (Hitesh Choudhary, Striver)	Large audiences	No documented devtool sponsorship deals
Razorpay FTX hackathon	Free conference tickets for applicants	No participation numbers
Postman Student Experts (India)	"Thousands of students" and "hundreds certified"	No aggregate numbers, in either pass
Certifications: GitHub (Jan 2024), HashiCorp, Databricks, dbt, SnowPro	Programmes confirmed	No counts of people certified; entry 57 has the numbers
Snyk Advisor	A page for every npm package	No traffic data
Linear's early waitlist	General mentions of hand-picked users	No primary source or numbers
Warp's waitlist	Pricing pages only	No waitlist numbers
Tailscale and Railway Discord-first support	Communities exist	No numbers
Vercel and Netlify hobby tiers	Well known	No source tying the free tier to conversion
Cursor free Pro for students (May 2025)	Reported by third parties	Cursor's students page no longer shows the offer
Linear "magic words" GitHub integration	Mechanism documented	No numbers
Graphite stack comment on PRs	Comment exists	No growth source
Chromatic Storybooks, Figma Community files, "Open in Colab", Codecov badges, Gradio share links	All real share or embed loops	No counts found
shields.io badges	470M to 1.6B images a month, in fork READMEs only unverified	A nonprofit, and the figure is unsourced
Adaptavist ScriptRunner	Atlassian Marketplace app	Install and revenue claims only in snippets
Upstash powering Vercel KV (2023)	Partnership confirmed	No growth numbers; Context7 (entry 51) is stronger
incident.io Slack-native distribution	Slack-first product	No Slack directory numbers
Datadog on AWS Marketplace	A billion-dollar seller claim	Secondary snippet only

CANDIDATE	WHAT WAS CONFIRMED	WHY IT WAS CUT
Gremlin GameDays as a sales event	Product and how-to pages	No sales outcomes
Gifting to engineering leaders (Sendoso and similar)	Common practice	No devtool case study
Postman's usage-data enterprise motion	Job posts and "98% of the Fortune 500" claims	No primary source on how accounts are targeted
CTO dinner series (Dev.Pro and similar)	Run by services firms	No pipeline data
GitHub Copilot ROI calculators	Third-party calculators only	Folded into entry 66
Windsurf "Wave" release cadence	"Every 3.7 days"	The figure came from a blog of unclear origin
"Vibe coding" and "context engineering"	Collins Word of the Year 2025; Tobi Lütke's post on 18 Jun 2025 and Andrej Karpathy's on 25 Jun 2025	No company-level outcome from riding either term
llms.txt (Jeremy Howard, 3 Sep 2024)	About 844K sites in BuiltWith-type counts third-party	No major AI provider has confirmed using it, and SE Ranking found no link to AI citations; entry 4 covers agent-readable docs
LaunchDarkly and Harness category creation	A Forrester Wave "Strong Performer" mention (2024)	No primary source on analyst-led category coinage
Atlassian's no-sales-team model	Secondary blogs only	Runs opposite to an ABM-led enterprise launch
Gitpod's rebrand to Ona; Sourcegraph's enterprise pivot	Both happened	Not verified in time; the competitor guide covers Ona
Product Hunt launches	Common	No devtool case with signup numbers
Clerk's growth	"7% per week"	Origin of the figure unclear
Twilio docs, Supabase docs, PlanetScale docs	Docs-first reputations	No source tying the docs to an outcome
PostHog billboards and own ads	Listed as channels in the handbook	No source on specific stunts
Devtool direct mail or hardware drops	Anecdotes	No case study with numbers

C. Wrong premise, broken source, or now a warning

CANDIDATE	WHAT HAPPENED
The Pragmatic Engineer sponsorship	The newsletter takes no sponsors; only its podcast does. The idea was wrong from the start. Sponsor page

CANDIDATE	WHAT HAPPENED
Cal.com (open source as the sales deck)	Moved production code to closed source on 14 Apr 2026 over AI security concerns; the public code lives on as MIT-licensed Cal.diy without Teams or SSO. Now a warning, listed under "What not to copy". Implicator
Deno, "10 Things I Regret About Node.js" (2018)	Drew wide attention, but one source puts Deno at 1.9% usage against Node's 40.8% in Stack Overflow 2024 unverified . Reads more as a warning than a move.
Railway Help Station	"Railway Station" turned out to be Railway's internal app. A third-party tool, Answer Overflow, indexes Discord help channels, but no SEO effect could be verified.
launchweek.dev count	"122 launch weeks by 92 companies in 2024" appeared in a search summary; the page returned 404.
Loom shareable links	Not a devtool, and no conversion figures.

D. Folded into other entries

These were sourced and used, but as supporting evidence inside a stronger entry.

CANDIDATE	WHERE IT WENT
Puppet's State of DevOps report	Entry 41
METR's 2025 randomised trial	Counter-evidence in entry 42
OpenAI's SWE-bench Verified	Entry 43
Cloudflare's Workers vs Lambda latency tests	Entry 45
Gremlin's Chaos Conf	Entry 30
PostHog's handbook	Entry 18, alongside GitLab's
Supabase as open-source distribution	Entry 7 (Launch Week)
Arc's waitlist	Comparison in entry 12
Dependabot and Mend's Renovate	Entry 53
Netlify Deploy Previews	Entry 54
Netlify's deploy button and StackBlitz tutorials	Entry 55
Cognizant's record vibe-coding hackathon	Entry 50
Snowflake's India World Tour	Entry 62

CANDIDATE	WHERE IT WENT
Snowflake's One Million Minds and Nasscom FutureSkills Prime	Entry 58
Pulumi's HashiCorp credit offer and Snowflake's free SnowConvert	Entry 67
PostHog's merch costs	Entry 71
MCP as a standard (10,000+ published servers)	Entry 72; a "97M monthly SDK downloads" figure was found only on secondary sites
GitHub MCP Registry	Entry 51

E. Named but not researched to a source

Time ran out on these. They're starting points for a third pass, not findings.

- Docs and content: Docker, Dagger, Appwrite, Plausible, Vercel templates, Warp and Zed manifestos, Software Engineering Daily.
- Product loops: Raycast store, Warp Drive, Excalidraw, tldraw, Sentry and Datadog share links, RapidAPI, Readme.com, Mergify, CodeSandbox embeds, Gitpod and Codespaces buttons.
- Community and events: Replit bounties and hackathons, Figma free for education, JetBrains free for open source, Sourcegraph's free tier.
- Field and enterprise: GitLab "from Jenkins" and Datadog vs New Relic takeouts, JFrog swampUP, ElasticON Tour, GitHub Galaxy, Plato, customer advisory boards, AWS MAP-funded proofs of concept, Heroku add-ons, Stripe Apps.
- India: Hasura, Appsmith, Zoho Catalyst, Freshworks Refresh, GDG and I/O Extended, Microsoft Reactor Bengaluru, AWS Community Days India.